ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** one-act science-fiction play	It is a humorous play.
2	**(b)** books, which some mistook for something else	They did not know what books were.
3	**(c)** The retreat was ordered by Think-Tank.	Past passive.
4	**(a)** Claire Boiko	Claire Boiko wrote it.
5	**(b)** nursery rhymes	Mother Goose rhymes.
6	**(a)** an attack to take over a place	Invasion.
7	**(a)** Historian in a museum	A historian addresses the audience.
8	**(a)** as serious accounts of Earth's powerful weapons and people	They misread them literally.
9	**(c)** studies and writes about the past	Historian.
10	**(a)** a planned Martian invasion of Earth	He introduces a strange event of the past.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It is written by Claire Boiko (1) and is a humorous one-act science-fiction play (1).	1+1
12	They found rows of books (1) which some of them could not recognise as such (1).	1+1
13	A simple children's book of rhymes saved Earth (1) while no army or weapon was needed (1).	1+1
14	A Historian in a museum speaks (1) and introduces a strange past event, a planned Martian invasion (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Think-Tank is the pompous leader of the Martian expedition. He believes himself wise and always interprets things in a grand way. His comic misreading of the book saves Earth.	1+1+1
16	The Martians' ignorance of simple things is amusing. Their solemn reading of nursery rhymes is funny. The pompous language of Think-Tank adds comedy.	1+1+1
17	The Martians found a book and misread it. Both verbs are in the simple past.	1+1+1
	OR: Noodle is Think-Tank's assistant. He follows his leader but is a little more practical. He helps in reading the book and supports the decision.	1+1+1
18	Misunderstanding can lead to wrong decisions. Here it brings a happy result but could be harmful. We should seek proper knowledge before acting.	1+1+1
	OR: The invasion was cancelled. The army had to retreat. The historian told the story.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Pompous Martian commander (1). Confident in his own wisdom (1). Misreads the nursery rhymes (1). Takes a fearful decision to retreat (1). A comic figure who saves Earth by error (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). What happened in the library (1). Think-Tank's decision (1). Feelings (1). Hopes (1).	2+2+1
20	The Historian introduces the invasion (1). Martians land and find a library (1). They study a book of nursery rhymes (1). They misread it and fear Earth (1). They retreat; Earth is saved (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Noodle's report (1). Think-Tank's reading (1). Fear (1). Decision (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling it a serious play; it is a **humorous science-fiction play** by Claire Boiko, set in the future with Martians and Earthlings.
- Mixing the characters: **Think-Tank** (Martian chief), **Noodle**, Captain Omega, Lieutenant Iota and Sergeant Oop.
- Saying the book was a weapon; it was a book of **nursery rhymes (Mother Goose)** that the Martians misread as military secrets.
- Missing the irony: a simple book of *nursery rhymes* saved the planet because the Martians misunderstood it.

- Forgetting the setting: Probe One lands in the **Centerville Public Library** on Earth and the crew studies books.
- Writing the play summary in dialogue form; use *simple present tense* and third person.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** Humpty Dumpty	They read the rhyme as a warning.
2	**(a)** advance	Advance.
3	**(c)** invasion that never really took place	Mars planned an invasion.
4	**(d)** to call off the invasion and retreat	He ordered a retreat.
5	**(b)** Think-Tank said that they would retreat.	Backshift.
6	**(b)** 2040	The Martians planned it for 2040.
7	**(d)** they feared the supposed power of the Earthlings	Misunderstanding caused fear.
8	**(d)** self-important	Pompous = full of self-importance.
9	**(a)** Think-Tank	Think-Tank is the pompous commander.
10	**(c)** a children's book of nursery rhymes saved Earth	A childish book saved the planet.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It was a collection of Mother Goose nursery rhymes (1) which they took to be a serious record of Earth's strength (1).	1+1
12	It satirises the tendency to misunderstand (1) and the pomp of leaders who decide on partial knowledge (1).	1+1
13	Think-Tank was the pompous Martian commander (1) and Noodle was his assistant (1).	1+1
14	He took it to be a lesson on Earth's military power (1) and was frightened by the 'meaning' he imagined (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Not knowing what books were, the Martians guessed wrongly at their use. They even took them for something else at first. This humour shows their ignorance.	1+1+1
16	A war was avoided not by force but by a comic error. The play suggests that peace may come from understanding and even accident. It satirises militarism.	1+1+1
17	Nursery rhymes are simple and familiar to everyone. Their nonsense makes the Martians' serious reading comic. The contrast highlights misunderstanding.	1+1+1
	OR: The Martians took the nursery rhymes as serious facts. They saw the stories of strange characters as proof of Earth's strange powers. Think-Tank used them to decide on retreat.	1+1+1
18	The book stands for knowledge and imagination. Even a children's book holds power. It shows that culture can protect a world.	1+1+1
	OR: We often judge from limited knowledge. Like the Martians, we may build theories on wrong readings. The play warns against such hasty judgements.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	The book is Mother Goose rhymes (1). Martians misread it (1). They cancel the invasion (1). A simple book prevented war (1). The title is ironic (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). Book in the play (1). Benefits of reading (1). Imagination (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Define satire (1). Pomp of the leader (1). The comic misreading (1). Folly of war planning (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: War can come from misunderstanding (1). Fear stops it here (1). Peace is better (1). Leaders must be wise (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** using humour to criticise folly	Satire.
2	**(c)** Noodle	Noodle assists him.
3	**(c)** humorous and satirical	A comedy.
4	**(b)** imagines scientific or future events	Science fiction.
5	**(c)** Martian landing crew	They landed on Earth under Think-Tank.
6	**(a)** human beings' tendency to misunderstand and fear what they do not know	Misreading.
7	**(d)** past perfect	had + V3.
8	**(b)** in a library	They explored an Earth library.
9	**(c)** misunderstanding can have unexpected outcomes; do not judge without knowing	Moral.
10	**(d)** the Martians retreating and Earth being saved	The invasion is called off and Earth is saved.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The invasion never happened (1) and in time the planets became friendly (1).	1+1
12	They wanted to learn about the Earthlings before attacking (1) and hoped to find useful information there (1).	1+1
13	He ordered the invasion to be called off (1) and the Martians to return to Mars (1).	1+1
14	Knowledge should precede action (1) and prejudice and misunderstanding can have comic or tragic results (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He believed from the book that Earth had enormous strength. He feared defeat if he attacked. So he cancelled the invasion.	1+1+1
16	They considered Earthlings inferior and were ready to attack. But after the reading they feared them. Their attitude shifts from arrogance to fear.	1+1+1
17	It imagines Martians visiting Earth in the future. It uses this setting for satire on human behaviour. The fantasy lets the writer comment safely.	1+1+1
	OR: The Historian frames the story as a past event told to us. He explains the context and gives a comic perspective. His commentary links the play to later times.	1+1+1
18	Think-Tank said that they had to leave Earth. 'We must' becomes 'they had to'.	1+1+1
	OR: The ending shows Earth safe and friendship later with Mars. It gives a warm, light mood. It fits the comedy.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Martians misread the books (1). Their wrong conclusion changes their plans (1). In another case it could cause war (1). Need for proper knowledge (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: They imagine mighty warriors (1). Reality: nursery rhymes (1). Errors of reasoning (1). Comic contrast (1). Message (1).	2+2+1
20	The Martians enter (1). They do not know books (1). Humorous mistakes (1). They find a particular book (1). They read it seriously (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Place and time (1). The cause (1). Statements (1). Concluding line (1).	2+2+1

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